

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 8 3

♥ Q J 10 6 4 2

♦ 7 3

♣ 4 2

♠ K J 7

♥ A 9 5

♦ J 10 9 2

♣ A K 10



♠ 9 5 4 2

♥ 7 3

♦ A 8 4

♣ Q J 9 6

♠ Q 10 6

♥ K 8

♦ K Q 6 5

♣ 8 7 5 3

West

2♥

All Pass

3NT by North

North

2NT

East

Pass

South

3NT

North's 2NT overcall shows a 1NT opening hand with ♥s stopped. North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♥7. West plays the ♥10.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=0 ♣=2 Total = 4

You will need to establish both ♠ and ♦ winners. If West holds both these Aces along with 6 ♥s to the Q J then you are going down. But of course West can't have that good a hand, he opened with a Weak-2. So East has one of the Aces.

If you knew which Ace West held you could make sure you attacked that suit first but unfortunately you have no way of knowing that. So instead you resort to a hold-up. Let West have the first ♥ and win the next ♥ in dummy.

Start on ♦s next, maybe because they are longer. Assume that East holds the ♦A and takes it on the third round of the suit.

East glares at you, (because he has no ♥ to lead), and plays the ♣Q which you take with your ♣A. Next you score your ♦ winners and play a ♠, taken by West with the ♠A.

[showcards N:ST,S6,C8,C7 S:SK,SJ,CK,CT]

West glares at you, (because you still have the ♥A), and plays another ♥ to your Ace. You take your 3 tricks and let East have the last ♣.

If you did not hold up on the first trick, but established ♦s first you would not have made the contract.

If you did not hold up on the first trick, but established ♠s first you would have made the contract even though you played incorrectly.

If you held up on the first trick you made the contract no matter which Ace East held.

Board 3
East Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A Q 6
♥ 8 4 2
♦ 7 6 5 2
♣ K Q 3

♠ J 10 8 7
♥ 6
♦ K J 10 9
♣ J 9 8 4

W N
S E

♠ K 5 2
♥ A J 7 3
♦ A 8 3
♣ A 7 6

♠ 9 4 3
♥ K Q 10 9 5
♦ Q 4
♣ 10 5 2

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

you throw out your ♥7 rather than the ♥3. Now South may think that North is encouraging him to continue, just what you want.

Sometimes it works, sometimes it doesn't.

I sure hope that when you play this hand South falls for your Bath Coup.

Because if he doesn't you're going to have to end-play him.

Do you see how that might happen?

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♥K. North plays the ♥6.

Winners: ♠=3 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 8

You just need one more winner and it could come from the ♦ suit if it happens to split 3-3. But you have another possibility. Suppose you let South hold the first trick and he decides to play another ♥? You would have two ♥ winners.

This isn't a true hold-up play although it does look like one. This play has the rather fancy name of Bath Coup, (named from Bath, England). Presumably South has led from ♥ K Q 10 9 5 and North has played his singleton ♥6. If South realizes that North has played his lowest card he will take that as a discouraging signal and will play a different suit. So